

Geography Paper 1 SL 2025 Marking Report

Options F and G Student Work

Basis for marking. This report marks plans/Geography_paper_1_SL_-2025-student-work.md against the questions in plans/Geography_paper_1_question_booklet_SL-2025.pdf. The supplied file plans/Geography_paper_1_HLSL_markscheme-2025.pdf appears to be a November 2025 markscheme and its Option F/G questions do not match this question booklet. Therefore, the short-answer marks below are awarded from the actual question-booklet stimulus and command terms, while the 10-mark essays are marked using the Paper 1 markbands extracted from the supplied markscheme. Spelling and grammar are ignored unless they affect geographical meaning.

Overall Mark

Question	Mark	Teacher rationale
Q11	10/10	All source-response parts are accurate. The student correctly identifies city skyscraper farms and the rooftop greenhouse categories, gives a valid disadvantage of vertical farming, and provides developed explanations for a physical change in production and a human change in consumption.
Q12(a)	7/10	Reaches the 7–8 band. The answer is focused on vector-borne disease diffusion, uses malaria throughout, and makes a relevant relative judgment that climate/geographic conditions are more important than economic factors. It remains at the lower end because the evidence is narrow, there is no place-specific case-study detail, and some disease terminology is imprecise.
Q13	10/10	The numerical answers are correct, and the explanations for ecological footprint, physical influences on residential pattern, and human influences on residential pattern all meet the marks available.
Q14(a)	8/10	A secure 7–8 band essay. The Shanghai answer examines two strategies—public transport and green space—with strengths and weaknesses for each. It does not reach 9–10 because the discussion sometimes conflates greenhouse gases with air pollutants, and the evaluation is not systematic enough for the top band.
Total	35/40	Strong performance across both options. The student is very secure on data-response and short explanation questions. The essay marks are lost mainly for limited breadth, limited case-study precision, and incomplete top-band evaluation.

Option F: Food and Health

Q11: Urban, Indoor and Vertical Food Production 10/10

Part	Mark	Rationale
11(a)(i)	1/1	City skyscraper farms is the production type shown in all three categories: urban, indoor and vertical.
11(a)(ii)	1/1	Urban and indoor are the two categories in which rooftop greenhouses are shown.
11(b)	2/2	The student identifies a valid disadvantage for farmers: vertical farming limits the range of crops, especially tall-growing crops. The answer develops this by explaining that stacked growing spaces limit crop height.
11(c)(i)	3/3	The response identifies climate change/drought as a physical influence, explains that drought risk changes over time, and develops the production response through drought-resistant crops or irrigation.
11(c)(ii)	3/3	The response identifies urbanization/employment change as a human factor, explains the shift from manual labour to office work, and links this to demand for convenient ultra-processed foods rather than staple-based diets.

Q12(a): Vector-Borne Disease Diffusion 7/10

This answer fits the 7–8 markband because it addresses the whole question and makes a clear relative judgment. It argues that geographic features and climate are the most important controls on malaria diffusion because the mosquito vector depends on warm conditions, standing water and suitable environments. The answer then considers economic factors, especially health infrastructure, vaccination/treatment availability and sanitation, as secondary influences on the rate of diffusion.

The mark is held at **7/10** rather than higher because the support is general. A top-band response would use more precise place evidence, for example named regions where malaria transmission is limited by altitude, temperature, drainage or public-health infrastructure. The answer also contains some terminology weaknesses: malaria is caused by a parasite rather than a virus, and the discussion of vaccines/treatments is relevant to control but less directly linked to geographic diffusion than vector habitat, climate, water and mobility.

To move this to **9–10**, the student should compare several geographic factors more systematically: climate, altitude, water availability, land use, settlement density, mobility, poverty and public-health infrastructure. The final judgment should explain where and why one set of factors becomes more important than another.

Option G: Urban Environments

Q13: The 15-Minute City 10/10

Part	Mark	Rationale
13(a)(i)	1/1	13.5% is an acceptable estimate for citizens more than 15 minutes from essential destinations.
13(a)(ii)	1/1	6 minutes is correct: the six times 4, 5, 4, 6.5, 8.5 and 8 minutes average to 6 minutes.
13(b)	2/2	The response states that a 15-minute city reduces dependence on cars and develops this with lower greenhouse-gas emissions. This is a valid way to reduce ecological footprint.
13(c)(i)	3/3	Mountains/steep slopes are a valid physical factor. The answer explains that building on steep slopes is harder, so residential areas are more likely to be built around them rather than on them.
13(c)(ii)	3/3	Access to essential goods and services is a valid human factor. The answer explains that residences are more likely to cluster near services, especially where congestion makes car travel less attractive and walkability more important.

Q14(a): Reducing Air Pollution in Shanghai 8/10

This essay securely reaches the 7–8 band. It is focused on the command term **examine** and on the required issue of strategies to reduce air pollution in an urban area. Shanghai is used consistently as the urban example. The student examines two strategies: improving public transportation and increasing green space.

The public transport paragraph has clear strengths: high-capacity transit can replace many individual car journeys, reduce traffic congestion and reduce idling emissions. It also gives useful case-specific support, including the long metro network and more than 10 million daily riders. The weakness is also valid: public transport has high construction costs and may still rely on electricity generated from fossil fuels.

The green-space paragraph is also balanced. The student explains that trees can trap particulate matter and absorb pollutants such as CO_2 , NO_2 and SO_2 , and can cool urban areas through shade and evapotranspiration. The weakness is relevant: green space has a weaker direct impact than reducing anthropogenic emissions and is seasonally dependent where trees lose leaves.

The essay does not reach **9–10** because the evaluation is not fully systematic. Some discussion is stronger for greenhouse-gas reduction than for local air pollution, and the answer would be sharper if it separated particulate matter, nitrogen oxides, sulphur dioxide and carbon dioxide. A top-band answer would compare the two strategies directly, explain which is more effective for different pollutants and time scales, and support the judgment with more precise Shanghai evidence.

Main Targets

- In 10-mark essays, add named places and statistics that directly support the argument.
- Separate air pollutants from greenhouse gases when the question is specifically about air pollution.
- Make the final judgment more comparative: state which factor or strategy is more important, for which places, pollutants or time scales, and why.
- Keep the clear short-answer structure; the data-response and 3-mark explanations are already very strong.